Echoes · Going live

Stripe verification is done. These are the last steps to switch from test payments to real payments. About 30–45 minutes in total.

Who does what

WHO	WHAT	WHEN
CC	Push the small Settings fix (typing your name now works normally).	Today
Helen's mom	A. Approve the Vercel Pro plan (needed once the site takes real money). B. Check the Stripe business details and bank account. C. Use her card for one $19.99 test purchase (refunded right after).	Before Helen's step 5
Helen	Steps 1–6: set up live mode in Stripe, update Vercel, redeploy, then run the final test.	After mom's A

Helen's mom 3 things

1. **Vercel Pro.** Vercel's free plan is for non-commercial projects only. Once Echoes charges money it should be on Pro (about US$20/month). In Vercel → **Settings → Billing** → upgrade to Pro.
2. **Stripe details.** In Stripe (Live mode) → **Settings → Business → Public details**, check:
   • Public business name: **Echoes** • Support email: **hello@echoestory.com** • Website: **echoestory.com**
   • Statement descriptor (what shows on card statements): e.g. **ECHOESTORY**
   Also check **Settings → Payouts** shows the right bank account.
3. **Test purchase.** When Helen reaches step 6, use your card to buy the $19.99 lifetime plan once. Helen refunds it in Stripe straight after; the money returns to the card in 5–10 days.

Helen 6 steps (in this order)

> **Keys stay secret.** Copy keys only from Stripe straight into Vercel. Never paste them in Slack, email or chat, and never screenshot them.

1. **Stripe → switch to Live mode** (toggle at the top right; turn off "Test mode" / leave the sandbox).
   Go to **Product catalog**. Create the two prices again in Live mode (test prices don't carry over — you can open each test product and use **"Copy to live mode"**):

• Family monthly — **US$4.99 / month**, recurring
• Family lifetime — **US$19.99**, one-time
Copy each **Price ID** (starts with `price_`) into a private note for step 4.

2. **Stripe (Live) → Developers → Webhooks → Add endpoint**
   URL: `https://echoestory.com/api/stripe-webhook`
   Events — select these 3: `checkout.session.completed`, `customer.subscription.updated`, `customer.subscription.deleted`
   Save, then click **Reveal signing secret** (starts with `whsec_`) — needed in step 4.
3. **Stripe (Live) → Settings → Billing → Customer portal → Activate.**
   This makes the "Manage subscription" button in Echoes work with real subscriptions. (Live and test are set up separately.)
4. **Vercel → echoes project → Settings → Environment Variables** (Production). Edit these 5:

NAME	NEW VALUE
`STRIPE_SECRET_KEY`	Stripe Live → Developers → API keys → **Secret key** (`sk_live_…`)
`STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET`	the `whsec_…` from step 2
`STRIPE_PRICE_ID`	the live **monthly** Price ID
`STRIPE_PRICE_ID_LIFETIME`	the live **lifetime** Price ID
`BILLING_MODE`	`stripe`

   Double-check: the secret key starts with `sk_live_` (not `sk_test_`, not `whsec_`).
5. **Vercel → Deployments → latest → ⋯ → Redeploy.**
   Only after step 4 is saved — new values are picked up only by a new deployment. Wait until it shows **Ready**.
6. **Final test** (with mom's card):
   ☐ echoestory.com opens; sign up with a new email → the verification email arrives
   ☐ Record a short story → it turns into text
   ☐ Settings → Upgrade → **Lifetime $19.99** → pay on the Stripe page
   ☐ Back in Echoes, Settings shows **Lifetime**
   ☐ Stripe (Live) → Payments shows the $19.99
   ☐ Open that payment → **Refund**
   All boxes ticked = **Echoes is live.** Send CC a short message: "Live test passed."

> **If something goes wrong:** tell CC which step and what you saw on screen (no keys in the message). Most common cause: step 5 done before step 4, or a key pasted into the wrong field.

Optional clean-up: old test subscriptions in Stripe's sandbox can be cancelled any time — they never charge real money.